Between the years 1973 and 1976, I served as the head of the Mossad's operations department. During the period immediately following the Yom Kippur War, I was closely involved, along with Zvi Zamir, director of the Mossad at the time, in everything related to the Agranat Commission and the establishment of the Mossad's research division following the commission's decision. I point this out because I believe that this very intense preoccupation with the issues of intelligence and assessment developed my ability to identify all kinds of nuances in the patterns of behavior and decision-making among our colleagues in Military Intelligence in the post-Agranat Commission era. I identified two things, one measurable and the other more psychological.

The first was that early warning of a war with Syria took first priority in MI's EEI during the second half of the 1970s and throughout the 1980s, at the expense of other issues, such as Iraq and Egypt. The second was that, as a general rule, MI's research refrained from dealing with assessments beyond the annual report. And the reason I use the term *psychological* to describe this is that when you have the threat of sanctions hovering over your head, it is only human to minimize the risk you take upon yourself. All of this was the background and the catalyst for the establishment of the strategic team in the Mossad's research department.

The strategic team was established at the beginning of 1989. Its mandate was to investigate key issues related to Israel's national security for a five-year and a ten-year time line. The team was composed of external experts who came from academia, the defense industries, and other bodies in the country engaged in intelligence research. The team was multidisciplinary and comprised no more than ten people. Its composition was not fixed—it changed according to the research topic. Only the best people in their respective fields were selected. The research topics were chosen by a team that included the Mossad director, the head of the research department, and the head of the team itself, the late Dr. Ilan Amit, who served in the role for many years, starting from the team's establishment. I would like to take this opportunity to express my gratitude to and admiration of this man, who in my humble opinion was one of the greatest Israeli thinkers, certainly among the people I knew. The team relied on the assistance of the research department personnel, who served as the team members' research assistants in every respect.